

BENCHMARK

RE-SCORED WITH THE RULE APPLIED TO EVERYONE

A like-for-like comparison of every Horizon Core Series rifle against its nearest current-production rivals from Fierce, Seekins, Christensen Arms, and Bergara. This corrected edition applies the report's own same-spec scoring rule **consistently** — an identical guarantee earns an identical score for every brand, Horizon included — and refreshes every price and contested spec against live 2026 manufacturer sources.

Where a competitor wins, it is named and ranked first. After correction, Horizon tops **3 of 14**.

20 RIVALS

current production, role-matched

9 CRITERIA

identical for every brand

LIVE MSRP

pulled 2026-07-01

01 / METHOD

HOW EVERY RIFLE IS SCORED

Each Horizon model is compared with the closest current-production rival from each competitor brand, matched on role/class and barrel construction. Every rifle — Horizon included — is scored on the same nine 0–10 criteria with fixed weights (below) and no brand weighting; the weighted total is the dot-product of scores and weights. This corrected edition changes none of that machinery. It changes the **inputs**: the same-spec rule below is now applied to Horizon exactly as to rivals, and every price and contested spec is refreshed against live 2026 sources.

 0 No relevant offering	 1–3 Poor — clear shortfall	 4–6 Average to good	 7 Good — no real caveat	 8 Good, with added value	 9 Very good — significant value	 10 Excellent & exceptional
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CRITERION	WEIGHT	WHAT IT REWARDS (APPLIED IDENTICALLY TO ALL BRANDS)
Accuracy	20%	Published accuracy guarantee, scored by the guarantee tier — identical guarantees score identically. A maker shipping a per-rifle fired test target (demonstrated proof) is credited one tier above an unverified claim.
Accessories	15%	Rails, bases, muzzle devices, bottom metal, bundled extras and configurability included as delivered.
Weight / Handling	15%	Carry weight and balance for the rifle's role; lighter is rewarded where the class calls for it.
Stock / Chassis	12%	Stock or chassis quality, adjustability, material and fit for purpose.
Caliber / chambering	10%	Breadth of factory chamberings actually offered on the model.
Barrel	9%	Barrel maker, material (carbon vs steel), profile and finish.
Trigger	9%	Trigger scored by trigger model — the same trigger earns the same score for every brand.
Magazine	5%	Magazine type, capacity, feed reliability and bottom-metal design.
Value (MSRP)	5%	MSRP value at the model's live 2026 price — weighted 5% by design (see neutrality note).

NEUTRALITY & WHAT CHANGED — This edition enforces the report's own stated rule that **a guarantee is a claim, not a measurement**, and applies it in both directions: an identical 0.5 MOA guarantee now scores identically for Horizon and Fierce (both 9.0), and an identical trigger scores identically for every brand. The prior edition credited Horizon +0.2–0.6 on the 20%-weighted Accuracy criterion that no rival with an equal guarantee received; that single-direction edge is removed here. Verified spec corrections are also applied (Fierce CT Rival XP is titanium / C3 carbon / 0.5 MOA / 6 lb; Christensen MPR is 6.9 lb, not 8–10; Seekins publishes MSRP; several chambering counts were low). **Value remains weighted 5%** — a disclosed choice that structurally mutes price; because Horizon is the highest-priced brand in most matchups, the real purchase-price gaps (hundreds of dollars, see spreads) are larger than that 5% conveys.

02 / RESULTS

EVERY MATCHUP, HONEST WINNER

With the same-spec rule applied consistently and specs/prices corrected, Horizon takes the top weighted score in **3 of 14** matchups — its genuine wins are the premium broad-chambering hunters (Venatic Carbon 2, Venatic 2) plus the uncontested-niche Vandal Bloodline. Vandal Prime 2 is now a coin-flip that tips to Fierce. Elsewhere a correctly-weighted Fierce, Seekins or Christensen leads. This is the paper picture; the delivery lens (04 / DELIVERY) tells a very different story.

#	HORIZON MODEL	MSRP	HORIZON	TOP-SCORING RIFLE IN MATCHUP	RESULT
1	Venatic Carbon 2	\$3,999	8.84	Venatic Carbon 2 (8.84)	Horizon tops
2	Venatic 2	\$3,799	8.71	Venatic 2 (8.71)	Horizon tops
3	Vandal Prime 2	\$2,999	8.65	Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68)	Fierce tops
4	Venatic DM	\$4,499	8.62	Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 (8.80)	Fierce tops
5	Vandal Carbon 2	\$3,399	8.58	Seekins Element M3 (8.76)	Seekins tops
6	Vandal DM	\$2,999	8.37	Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 (8.77)	Fierce tops
7	Venatic Riff	\$3,799	8.37	Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 (8.80)	Fierce tops
8	Venatic Max	\$3,999	8.28	Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 (8.77)	Fierce tops
9	Vandal 2	\$2,299	8.27	Fierce Carbon Rogue (8.51)	Fierce tops
10	Vandal X	\$2,799	8.17	Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68)	Fierce tops
11	Vandal Bloodline	\$2,799	8.14	Vandal Bloodline (8.14)	Horizon tops
12	Vandal Dark II	\$2,999	8.11	Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68)	Fierce tops
13	Villain	\$2,499	8.07	Fierce Carbon Rogue (8.51)	Fierce tops
14	Vena-Bull	\$9,999	7.79	Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 (8.77)	Fierce tops

Ranked by the Horizon model's own weighted score, highest first. "Top-scoring rifle" is the highest weighted total in that matchup after correction. † = discontinued rival retained as legacy analog (no current-production replacement in class). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

ULTRALIGHT CARBON BACKCOUNTRY
HUNTER

VENATIC CARBON 2

Proof Research carbon barrel · Stiller Wombat action · iota EKO
X carbon stock · ARCA + Picatinny · flush-fit magazine · 0.5
MOA guarantee.

MSRP **\$3,999**

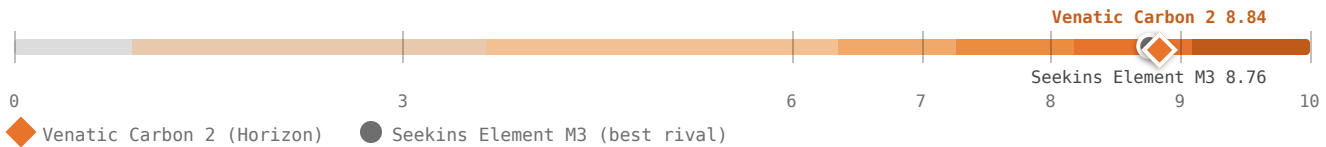
Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed · 6.5 Creed ·
6mm ARC · 308 Win · 280 AI · 6.5 PRC · 7 PRC ·
7mm Backcountry · 300 Win · 300 PRC
Barrel: Proof Research carbon · lengths vary by
chambering — 16.5", 18", 20", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted
score: Venatic Carbon 2 (8.84).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.84



CRITERION / WEIGHT	VENATIC CARBON 2	SEEKINS ELEMENT M3	FIERCE CARBON ROGUE	BERGARA PREMIER CIMA PRO	CHRISTENSEN RIDGELINE FFT TI
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	8.5	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.8	9.0	8.0	8.4	8.4
Weight / Handling 15%	8.9	9.1	9.0	9.3	9.7
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.8	8.8	8.4	8.5	8.6
Caliber / chambering 10%	9.2	9.0	8.4	8.8	9.0
Barrel 9%	9.0	8.5	8.7	8.4	8.7
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.3	8.0	8.0	7.4
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.2	8.0	8.4	8.0	7.8
Weighted total	8.84	8.76	8.51	8.52	8.60

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Venatic Carbon 2 (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Venatic Carbon 2 (9.2)
- **Weight:** Christensen Ridgeline FFT Ti (9.7)
- **Trigger:** Venatic Carbon 2 (9.0)
- **Value:** Fierce Carbon Rogue (8.4)

ANALYST NOTE

The Venatic Carbon 2 posts the top weighted score here (8.84 of 10), ahead of Seekins Element M3 (8.76). The Horizon model rates highest on caliber / chambering (9.2) and accuracy (9.0) and lowest on value (msrp) (7.2) and magazine (8.6). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

PREMIUM STEEL-BARREL LIGHTWEIGHT HUNTER

VENATIC 2

Benchmark 416R steel barrel · Stiller Wombat action · Iota EKO X stock · ARCA + Picatinny · flush-fit magazine · 0.5 MOA guarantee.

MSRP **\$3,799**

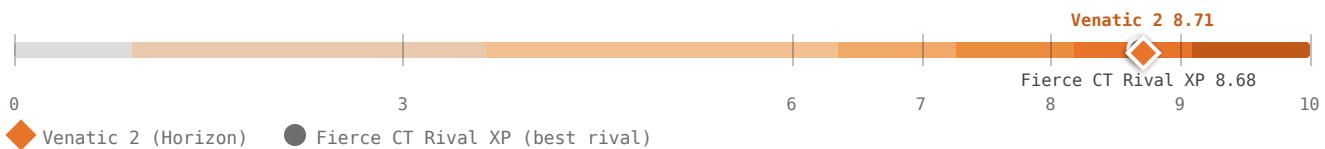
Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed · 6.5 Creed · 6mm ARC · 308 Win · 280 AI · 6.5 PRC · 7 PRC · 7mm Backcountry · 300 Win · 300 PRC
Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · lengths vary by chambering – 16.5", 18", 20", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Venatic 2 (8.71).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.71



CRITERION / WEIGHT	VENATIC 2	SEEKINS HAVAK PH3	FIERCE CT RIVAL XP	BERGARA B-14 SQ. CREST	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.8	8.6	8.5	8.0	8.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.3	8.0	8.9	8.4	9.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.8	8.4	8.7	8.5	8.4
Caliber / chambering 10%	9.2	8.6	8.2	7.6	8.6
Barrel 9%	8.4	8.3	8.7	8.0	8.0
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.4	8.2	8.0	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.4	8.0	8.0	8.8	9.0
Weighted total	8.71	8.44	8.68	8.12	8.36

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Venatic 2 (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Venatic 2 (9.2)
- **Weight:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)
- **Trigger:** Venatic 2 (9.0)
- **Value:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)

ANALYST NOTE

The Venatic 2 posts the top weighted score here (8.71 of 10), ahead of Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68). The Horizon model rates highest on caliber / chambering (9.2) and accuracy (9.0) and lowest on value (msrp) (7.4) and weight / handling (8.3). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Havak PH3 \$1,895 · Fierce CT Rival XP \$2,999 · Bergara B-14 Sq. Crest \$1,879 · Christensen Mesa FFT \$1,499.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

VERSATILE STEEL-BARREL ALL-ROUNDER

VANDAL PRIME 2

Benchmark 416R steel barrel, 22 in · Stiller Hyrax action · Iota BKH carbon stock · ARCA + Picatinny · flush magazine · 0.5 MOA guarantee.

MSRP **\$2,999**

Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed · 6.5 Creed · 308 Win · 6.5 PRC · 7mm Backcountry · 280 AI · 300 Win · 300 PRC · 7 PRC

Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.65

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL PRIME 2	SEEKINS HAVAK PH3	FIERCE CT RIVAL XP	BERGARA B-14 SQ. CREST	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.8	8.6	8.5	8.0	8.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.0	8.0	8.9	8.4	9.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.7	8.4	8.7	8.5	8.4
Caliber / chambering 10%	9.0	8.6	8.2	7.6	8.6
Barrel 9%	8.4	8.3	8.7	8.0	8.0
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.4	8.2	8.0	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.8	8.0	8.0	8.8	9.0
Weighted total	8.65	8.44	8.68	8.12	8.36

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vandal Prime 2 (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Vandal Prime 2 (9.0)
- **Weight:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)
- **Trigger:** Vandal Prime 2 (9.0)
- **Value:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce CT Rival XP posts the top weighted score (8.68); the Vandal Prime 2 ranks #2 of 5 at 8.65. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and caliber / chambering (9.0) and lowest on value (msrp) (7.8) and weight / handling (8.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Havak PH3 \$1,895 · Fierce CT Rival XP \$2,999 · Bergara B-14 Sq. Crest \$1,879 · Christensen Mesa FFT \$1,499.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

FOLDING-CHASSIS CARBON HUNTER
(DETACHABLE MAG)

VENATIC DM

Proof Research carbon barrel · DLC-coated Stiller Wombat · folding chassis ≈ 6 lb 10 oz · AICS detachable · 0.5 MOA guarantee.

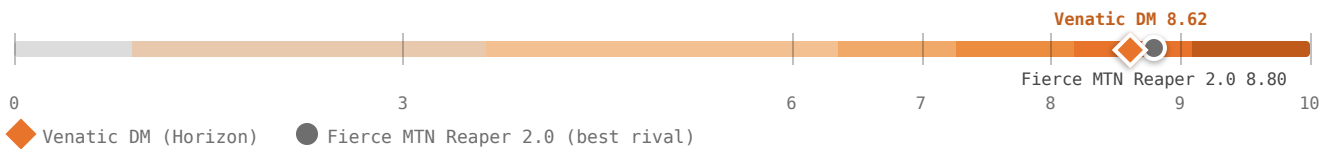
MSRP **\$4,499**

Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed · 6.5 Creed · 308 Win · 300 Win · 7 PRC (18 / 20 / 22 in)
Barrel: Proof Research carbon · lengths vary by chambering – 18", 20", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 (8.80).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.62

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VENATIC DM	SEEKINS ELEMENT M3	FIERCE MTN REAPER 2.0	BERGARA PREMIER MGLITE	CHRISTENSEN MPR
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	9.0	9.0	8.8	8.6	9.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.7	9.1	9.0	8.7	8.6
Stock / Chassis 12%	9.0	8.8	9.0	8.8	9.0
Caliber / chambering 10%	7.0	9.0	8.6	8.0	8.8
Barrel 9%	9.0	8.5	8.8	8.5	8.5
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.3	8.0	8.8	8.8
Value (MSRP) 5%	6.8	8.0	7.8	7.8	8.0
Weighted total	8.62	8.76	8.80	8.46	8.62

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Venatic DM (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Seekins Element M3 (9.0)
- **Weight:** Seekins Element M3 (9.1)
- **Trigger:** Venatic DM (9.0)
- **Value:** Seekins Element M3 (8.0)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 posts the top weighted score (8.80); the Venatic DM ranks #3 of 5 at 8.62. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and accessories (9.0) and lowest on value (msrp) (6.8) and caliber / chambering (7.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Element M3 \$2,895 · Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 \$3,199 · Bergara Premier Mglite \$3,099 · Christensen MPR \$2,299.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

BACKCOUNTRY CARBON-BARRELED VANDAL

VANDAL CARBON 2

Proof Research carbon Sendero Light barrel • Stiller Hyrax action • Iota EKO X stock • 20 MOA rail • AICS magazine • 0.5 MOA guarantee.

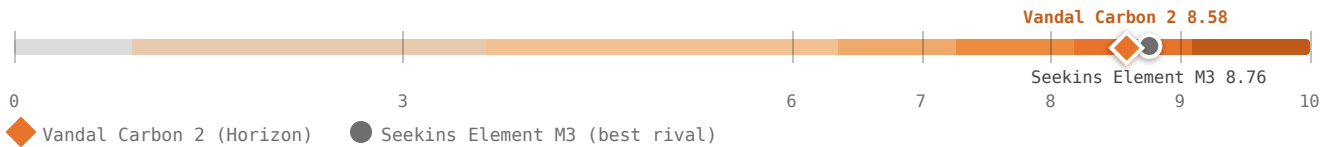
MSRP **\$3,399**

Chamberings: 22 Creed • 25 Creed • 308 Win • 280 AI • 7 PRC • 300 Win • 300 PRC
Barrel: Proof Research carbon • lengths vary by chambering – 18", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Seekins Element M3 (8.76).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.58


CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL CARBON 2	SEEKINS ELEMENT M3	FIERCE CARBON RAGE LR	BERGARA PREMIER MGLITE	CHRISTENSEN RIDGELINE
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.6	9.0	8.8	8.6	8.2
Weight / Handling 15%	8.5	9.1	8.6	8.7	9.1
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.6	8.8	8.8	8.8	8.2
Caliber / chambering 10%	7.6	9.0	8.4	8.0	8.8
Barrel 9%	9.0	8.5	8.8	8.5	8.6
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.3	8.2	8.8	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.4	8.0	7.6	7.8	8.4
Weighted total	8.58	8.76	8.70	8.46	8.43

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vandal Carbon 2 (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Seekins Element M3 (9.0)
- **Weight:** Seekins Element M3 (9.1)
- **Trigger:** Vandal Carbon 2 (9.0)
- **Value:** Christensen Ridgeline (8.4)

ANALYST NOTE

Seekins Element M3 posts the top weighted score (8.76); the Vandal Carbon 2 ranks #3 of 5 at 8.58. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and barrel (9.0) and lowest on value (msrp) (7.4) and caliber / chambering (7.6). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Element M3 \$2,895 • Fierce Carbon Rage LR \$3,450 • Bergara Premier Mglite \$3,099 • Christensen Ridgeline \$2,049.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

PRECISION CHASSIS RIFLE (XLR ELEMENT)

VANDAL DM

Benchmark 416R steel • Stiller Hyrax • XLR Element 4.0 chassis • integrated level • RRS dovetail/ARCA • AICS • 0.5 MOA
guarantee ≈ 8 lb 13 oz.

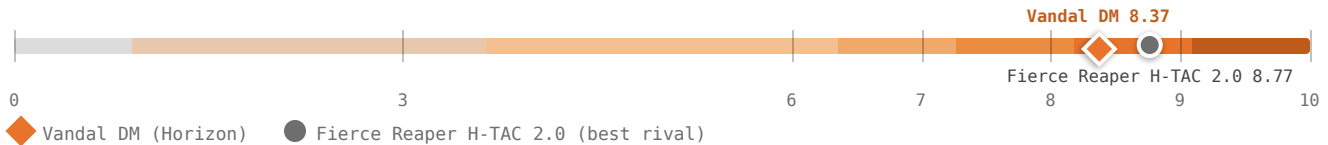
MSRP **\$2,999**

Chamberings: 22 Creed • 25 Creed • 6.5 Creed • 308 Win • 300 Win • 7 PRC
Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless • lengths vary by chambering – 18", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 (8.77).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.37

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL DM	SEEKINS HIT PRO M3	FIERCE REAPER H-TAC 2.0	BERGARA PREMIER LRP †	CHRISTENSEN MPR
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	9.0	9.3	8.8	8.6	9.0
Weight / Handling 15%	7.0	6.6	8.5	6.8	8.6
Stock / Chassis 12%	9.0	9.4	9.0	8.7	9.0
Caliber / chambering 10%	7.0	7.6	8.6	7.8	8.8
Barrel 9%	8.4	8.6	8.8	8.4	8.5
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.5	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.7	8.7	8.8	8.8
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.8	8.2	8.0	8.4	8.0
Weighted total	8.37	8.45	8.77	8.16	8.62

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vandal DM (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Christensen MPR (8.8)
- **Weight:** Christensen MPR (8.6)
- **Trigger:** Seekins HIT Pro M3 (9.5)
- **Value:** Bergara Premier LRP † (8.4)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 posts the top weighted score (8.77); the Vandal DM ranks #4 of 5 at 8.37. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and accessories (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (7.0) and weight / handling (7.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins HIT Pro M3 \$2,400 • Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 \$2,699 • Bergara Premier LRP † ≈\$2,000 (disc.) • Christensen MPR \$2,299.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01. † Bergara Premier LRP is discontinued; its last-published spec is retained only as a legacy analog (no current-production Bergara replacement in this class).

13" SBR / COMPACT TRUCK RIFLE

VENATIC RIFF

13 in barrel (SBR) · Stiller Wombat action · Iota EKO stock · TriggerTech Rough Diamond · compact, suppressor-ready concept.

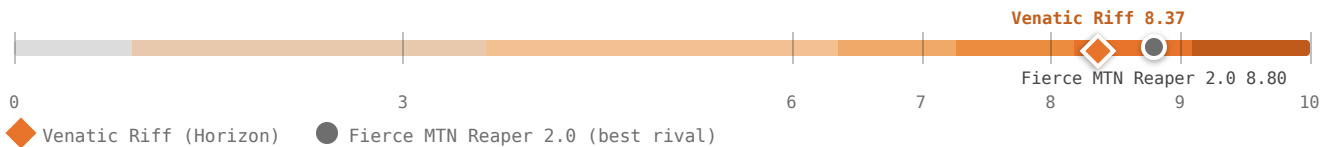
MSRP **\$3,799**

Chamberings: 22 Creed · 308 Win · 6mm ARC
Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · 13" (SBR)



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 (8.80).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.37

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VENATIC RIFF	SEEKINS HIT PRO M3	FIERCE MTN REAPER 2.0	BERGARA PREMIER LRP †	CHRISTENSEN MPR
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.6	9.3	8.8	8.6	9.0
Weight / Handling 15%	9.0	6.6	9.0	6.8	8.6
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.5	9.4	9.0	8.7	9.0
Caliber / chambering 10%	5.5	7.6	8.6	7.8	8.8
Barrel 9%	8.2	8.6	8.8	8.4	8.5
Trigger 9%	9.5	9.5	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.4	8.7	8.0	8.8	8.8
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.0	8.2	7.8	8.4	8.0
Weighted total	8.37	8.45	8.80	8.16	8.62

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Venatic Riff (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Christensen MPR (8.8)
- **Weight:** Venatic Riff (9.0)
- **Trigger:** Venatic Riff (9.5)
- **Value:** Bergara Premier LRP † (8.4)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 posts the top weighted score (8.80); the Venatic Riff ranks #4 of 5 at 8.37. The Horizon model rates highest on trigger (9.5) and accuracy (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (5.5) and value (msrp) (7.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins HIT Pro M3 \$2,400 · Fierce MTN Reaper 2.0 \$3,199 · Bergara Premier LRP † ≈\$2,000 (disc.) · Christensen MPR \$2,299.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01. † Bergara Premier LRP is discontinued; its last-published spec is retained only as a legacy analog (no current-production Bergara replacement in this class).

LIMITED WOOD/ALUMINUM CHASSIS

VENATIC MAX

Lothar Walther 416R stainless barrel · Stiller Wombat action ·
WOOX Furiosa wood/aluminum chassis · 20 MOA rail · 0.5
MOA guarantee.

MSRP **\$3,999**

Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed · 308 Win
Barrel: Lothar Walther 416R stainless · lengths
vary by chambering – 18", 20", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 (8.77).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.28

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VENATIC MAX	SEEKINS HIT PRO M3	FIERCE REAPER H-TAC 2.0	BERGARA PREMIER LRP †	CHRISTENSEN MPR
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.8	9.3	8.8	8.6	9.0
Weight / Handling 15%	7.7	6.6	8.5	6.8	8.6
Stock / Chassis 12%	9.0	9.4	9.0	8.7	9.0
Caliber / chambering 10%	5.5	7.6	8.6	7.8	8.8
Barrel 9%	9.0	8.6	8.8	8.4	8.5
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.5	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.0	8.7	8.7	8.8	8.8
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.0	8.2	8.0	8.4	8.0
Weighted total	8.28	8.45	8.77	8.16	8.62

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Venatic Max (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Christensen MPR (8.8)
- **Weight:** Christensen MPR (8.6)
- **Trigger:** Seekins HIT Pro M3 (9.5)
- **Value:** Bergara Premier LRP † (8.4)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 posts the top weighted score (8.77); the Venatic Max ranks #4 of 5 at 8.28. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and stock / chassis (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (5.5) and value (msrp) (7.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins HIT Pro M3 \$2,400 · Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 \$2,699 · Bergara Premier LRP † ≈\$2,000 (disc.) · Christensen MPR \$2,299.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01. † Bergara Premier LRP is discontinued; its last-published spec is retained only as a legacy analog (no current-production Bergara replacement in this class).

TRADITIONAL ENTRY HUNTER

VANDAL 2

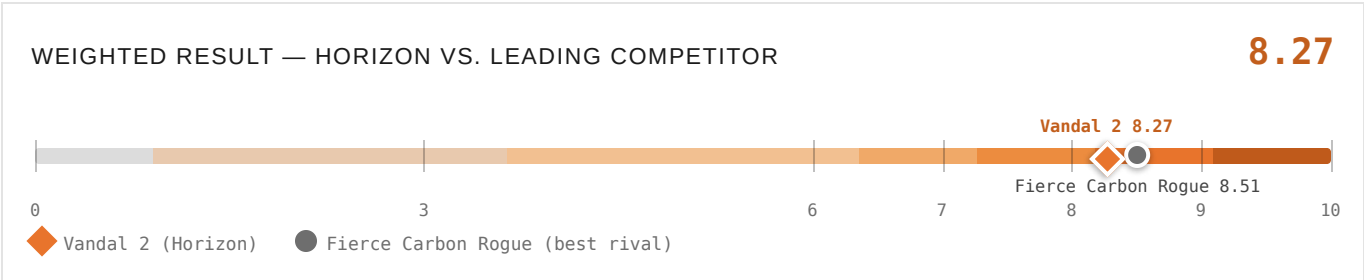
Benchmark 416R steel barrel · Stiller Hyrax action · iota BKH carbon stock · integrated ARCA/Pic · 20 MOA rail · 0.5 MOA guarantee.

MSRP \$2,299

Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed · 7 PRC
Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · lengths vary by chambering – 18", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce Carbon Rogue (8.51).**



CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL 2	SEEKINS HAVAK PH3	FIERCE CARBON ROGUE	BERGARA B-14 WILDERNESS	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	8.5	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.6	8.6	8.0	7.5	8.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.0	8.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.6	8.4	8.4	7.8	8.4
Caliber / chambering 10%	5.5	8.6	8.4	8.4	8.6
Barrel 9%	8.3	8.3	8.7	7.9	8.0
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.4	8.0	7.4	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	8.2	8.0	8.4	9.2	9.0
Weighted total	8.27	8.44	8.51	7.96	8.36

CATEGORY LEADERS

- Accuracy:** Vandal 2 (9.0)
- Chamberings:** Seekins Havak PH3 (8.6)
- Weight:** Fierce Carbon Rogue (9.0)
- Trigger:** Vandal 2 (9.0)
- Value:** Bergara B-14 Wilderness (9.2)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce Carbon Rogue posts the top weighted score (8.51); the Vandal 2 ranks #4 of 5 at 8.27. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and trigger (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (5.5) and weight / handling (8.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Havak PH3 \$1,895 · Fierce Carbon Rogue \$2,150 · Bergara B-14 Wilderness \$1,099 · Christensen Mesa FFT \$1,499.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

PREDATOR / PRECISION FLAGSHIP (22 CREED)

VANDAL X

Benchmark 416R steel, 3-flute spiral · Stiller Hyrax action · Iota EKO X stock · 20 MOA rail · AICS magazine · 0.5 MOA guarantee.

MSRP **\$2,799**

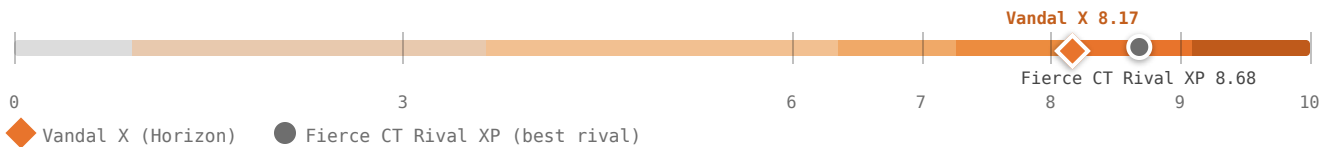
Chamberings: 22 Creed · 25 Creed

Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · lengths vary by chambering – 18", 22"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.17

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL X	SEEKINS HAVAK PH3 NRL	FIERCE CT RIVAL XP	BERGARA B-14 SQ. CREST	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.6	8.8	8.5	8.0	8.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.0	7.6	8.9	8.4	9.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.6	8.6	8.7	8.5	8.4
Caliber / chambering 10%	4.5	7.5	8.2	7.6	8.6
Barrel 9%	8.5	8.5	8.7	8.0	8.0
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	8.4	8.2	8.0	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.8	8.0	8.0	8.8	9.0
Weighted total	8.17	8.34	8.68	8.12	8.36

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vandal X (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Christensen Mesa FFT (8.6)
- **Weight:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)
- **Trigger:** Vandal X (9.0)
- **Value:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce CT Rival XP posts the top weighted score (8.68); the Vandal X ranks #4 of 5 at 8.17. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and trigger (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (4.5) and value (msrp) (7.8). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Havak PH3 NRL \$2,295 · Fierce CT Rival XP \$2,999 · Bergara B-14 Sq. Crest \$1,879 · Christensen Mesa FFT \$1,499.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

STRAIGHT-WALL 450 BUSHMASTER

VANDAL
BLOODLINE

Benchmark steel Varmint #5, threaded 11/16-24 · Stiller Hyrax action · Iota EKO stock · ARCA + Pic · 20 MOA rail · AICS · 6 lb 15 oz.

MSRP **\$2,799**

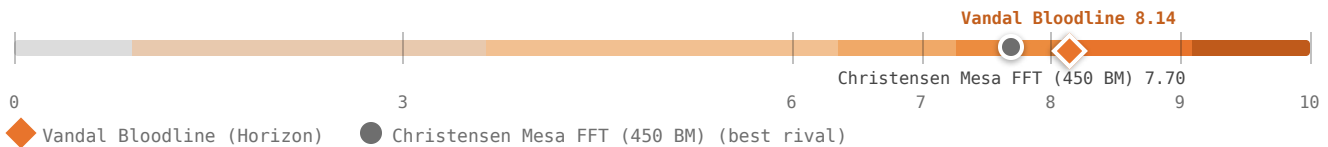
Chamberings: 450 Bushmaster

Barrel: Benchmark stainless · 16.5"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Vandal Bloodline (8.14).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.14

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL BLOODLINE	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT (450 BM)	BERGARA B-14 RIDGE (450 BM)
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.6	7.6	7.3
Weight / Handling 15%	8.4	8.6	8.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.5	8.0	7.5
Caliber / chambering 10%	4.0	4.0	4.0
Barrel 9%	8.3	7.9	7.8
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	8.0
Magazine 5%	8.6	7.0	7.2
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.6	8.8	9.0
Weighted total	8.14	7.70	7.43

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vandal Bloodline (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Vandal Bloodline (4.0)
- **Weight:** Christensen Mesa FFT (450 BM) (8.6)
- **Trigger:** Vandal Bloodline (9.0)
- **Value:** Bergara B-14 Ridge (450 BM) (9.0)

ANALYST NOTE

The Vandal Bloodline posts the top weighted score here (8.14 of 10), ahead of Christensen Mesa FFT (450 BM) (7.70). The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and trigger (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (4.0) and value (msrp) (7.6). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Christensen Mesa FFT (450 BM) \$1,499.99 · Bergara B-14 Ridge (450 BM) \$999.
Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

22 CREED PREDATOR / LONG-RANGE

VANDAL DARK II

Benchmark 416R steel, 18 in, 8-flute spiral · Stiller Hyrax action
· Iota EKO stock · full-length ARCA · Horizon DBM/SBM · 0.5
MOA guarantee.

MSRP **\$2,999**

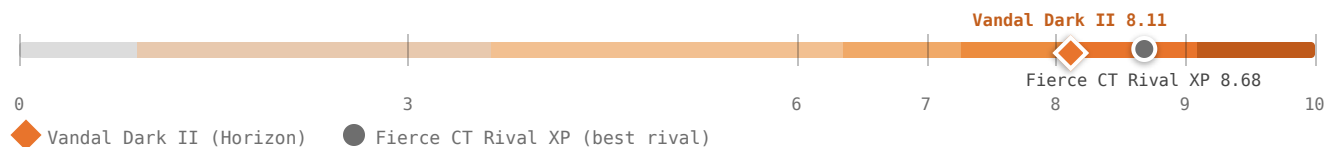
Chamberings: 22 Creed

Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · 18"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce CT Rival XP (8.68).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.11

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VANDAL DARK II	SEEKINS HAVAK PH3 NRL	FIERCE CT RIVAL XP	BERGARA B-14 SQ. CREST	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.8	8.8	8.5	8.0	8.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.2	7.6	8.9	8.4	9.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.6	8.6	8.7	8.5	8.4
Caliber / chambering 10%	3.5	7.5	8.2	7.6	8.6
Barrel 9%	8.5	8.5	8.7	8.0	8.0
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.4	8.4	8.2	8.0	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	7.6	8.0	8.0	8.8	9.0
Weighted total	8.11	8.34	8.68	8.12	8.36

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vandal Dark II (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Christensen Mesa FFT (8.6)
- **Weight:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)
- **Trigger:** Vandal Dark II (9.0)
- **Value:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce CT Rival XP posts the top weighted score (8.68); the Vandal Dark II ranks #5 of 5 at 8.11. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and trigger (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (3.5) and value (msrp) (7.6). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Havak PH3 NRL \$2,295 · Fierce CT Rival XP \$2,999 · Bergara B-14 Sq. Crest \$1,879 · Christensen Mesa FFT \$1,499.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

CLASSIC PREDATOR HUNTER

VILLAIN

Benchmark 416R stainless, 18 in, 1:8, threaded 5/8-24 · Stiller action · Iota EKO stock · 0-MOA Pic + full-length ARCA · 7 lb 5 oz.

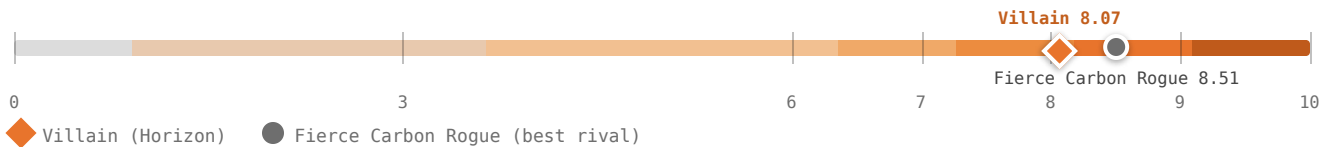
MSRP **\$2,499**

Chamberings: 22 Creed (primary) · 22-250 Rem
Barrel: Benchmark 416R stainless · 18"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce Carbon Rogue (8.51).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

8.07

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VILLAIN	SEEKINS HAVAK PH3	FIERCE CARBON ROGUE	BERGARA B-14 SQ. CREST	CHRISTENSEN MESA FFT
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	8.5	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.2	8.6	8.0	8.0	8.0
Weight / Handling 15%	8.2	8.0	9.0	8.4	9.0
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.3	8.4	8.4	8.5	8.4
Caliber / chambering 10%	4.5	8.6	8.4	7.6	8.6
Barrel 9%	8.4	8.3	8.7	8.0	8.0
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.0	9.0	8.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.0	8.4	8.0	8.0	7.3
Value (MSRP) 5%	8.0	8.0	8.4	8.8	9.0
Weighted total	8.07	8.44	8.51	8.12	8.36

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Villain (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Seekins Havak PH3 (8.6)
- **Weight:** Fierce Carbon Rogue (9.0)
- **Trigger:** Villain (9.0)
- **Value:** Christensen Mesa FFT (9.0)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce Carbon Rogue posts the top weighted score (8.51); the Villain ranks #5 of 5 at 8.07. The Horizon model rates highest on accuracy (9.0) and trigger (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (4.5) and value (msrp) (8.0). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins Havak PH3 \$1,895 · Fierce Carbon Rogue \$2,150 · Bergara B-14 Sq. Crest \$1,879 · Christensen Mesa FFT \$1,499.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01.

EXTREME LONG-RANGE SPECIALTY

VENA-BULL

ELR heavy barrel system · large/ELR action · 0.5 MOA guarantee · purpose-built extreme long-range platform with limited direct rivals in this group.

MSRP **\$9,999**

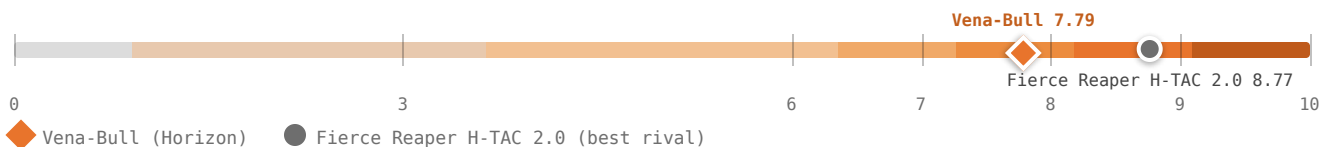
Chamberings: .375 CheyTac · .408 CheyTac

Barrel: ELR heavy barrel · 30"



Horizon image (official). Competitors shown spec-only. **Top weighted score: Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 (8.77).**

WEIGHTED RESULT — HORIZON VS. LEADING COMPETITOR

7.79

CRITERION / WEIGHT	VENA-BULL	SEEKINS HIT PRO M3	FIERCE REAPER H-TAC 2.0	BERGARA PREMIER LRP †	CHRISTENSEN MPR
Accuracy 20%	9.0	8.5	9.0	8.0	8.0
Accessories 15%	8.8	9.3	8.8	8.6	9.0
Weight / Handling 15%	5.5	6.6	8.5	6.8	8.6
Stock / Chassis 12%	8.8	9.4	9.0	8.7	9.0
Caliber / chambering 10%	4.5	7.6	8.6	7.8	8.8
Barrel 9%	9.2	8.6	8.8	8.4	8.5
Trigger 9%	9.0	9.5	9.0	9.0	9.0
Magazine 5%	8.0	8.7	8.7	8.8	8.8
Value (MSRP) 5%	6.0	8.2	8.0	8.4	8.0
Weighted total	7.79	8.45	8.77	8.16	8.62

CATEGORY LEADERS

- **Accuracy:** Vena-Bull (9.0)
- **Chamberings:** Christensen MPR (8.8)
- **Weight:** Christensen MPR (8.6)
- **Trigger:** Seekins HIT Pro M3 (9.5)
- **Value:** Bergara Premier LRP † (8.4)

ANALYST NOTE

Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 posts the top weighted score (8.77); the Vena-Bull ranks #5 of 5 at 7.79. The Horizon model rates highest on barrel (9.2) and accuracy (9.0) and lowest on caliber / chambering (4.5) and weight / handling (5.5). Scores reflect published specifications, not measured performance.

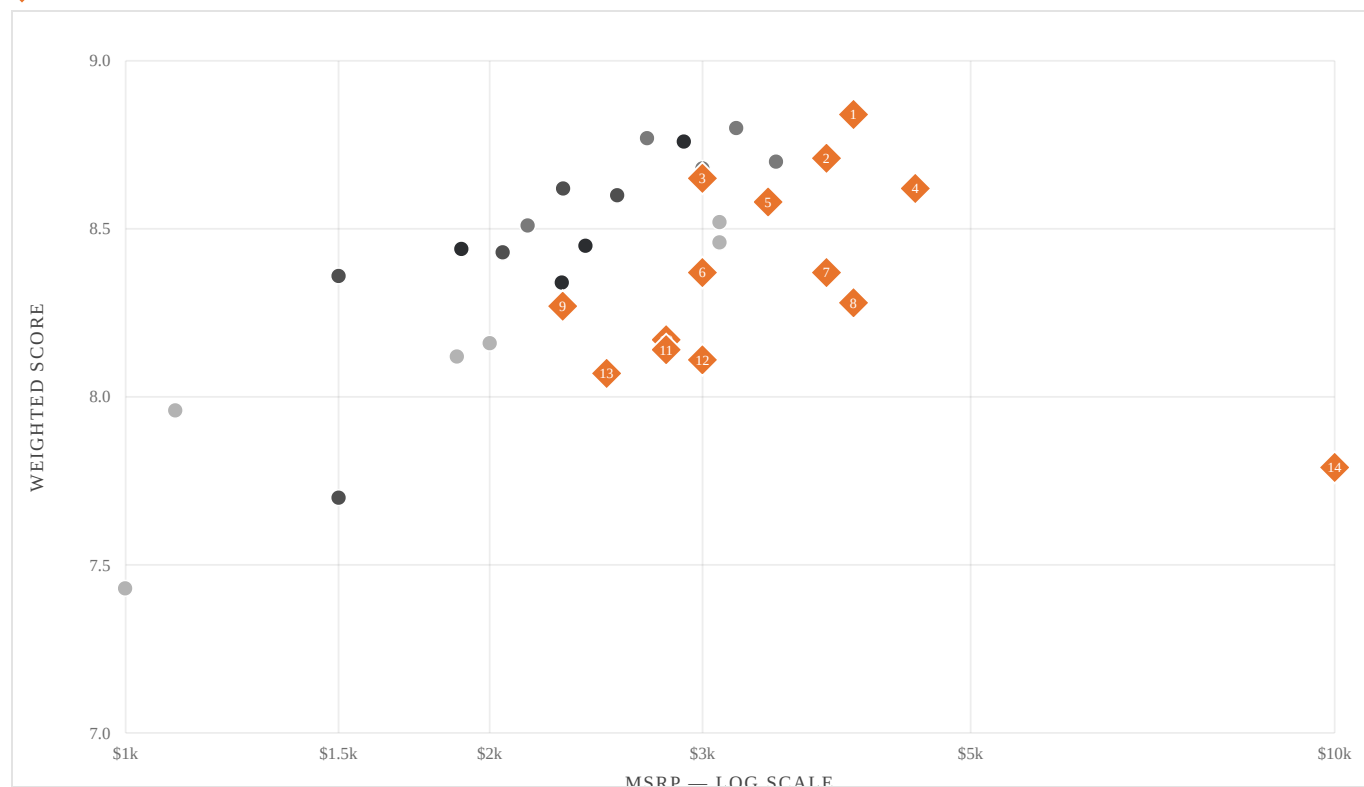
COMPETITOR MSRP (MSRP vs MSRP): Seekins HIT Pro M3 \$2,400 · Fierce Reaper H-TAC 2.0 \$2,699 · Bergara Premier LRP † ≈\$2,000 (disc.) · Christensen MPR \$2,299.99. Current-production models only, live 2026-07-01. † Bergara Premier LRP is discontinued; its last-published spec is retained only as a legacy analog (no current-production Bergara replacement in this class).

03 / FIELD MAP

PRICE VS. WEIGHTED SCORE

All 34 current-production rifles plotted by live MSRP (log scale) against their corrected weighted score. Horizon models are orange diamonds, numbered by overall rank; competitors are grey by brand. The vertical spread is compressed — after correcting the Accuracy inflation, the field is tightly packed on paper — while the horizontal spread (price) is wide: Horizon sits to the right (more expensive) at nearly every score band.

◆ Horizon ● Seekins ● Fierce ● Bergara ● Christensen



HORIZON MODELS BY RANK

- | | |
|--------------------|---------------------|
| 1 Venatic Carbon 2 | 8 Venatic Max |
| 2 Venatic 2 | 9 Vandal 2 |
| 3 Vandal Prime 2 | 10 Vandal X |
| 4 Venatic DM | 11 Vandal Bloodline |
| 5 Vandal Carbon 2 | 12 Vandal Dark II |
| 6 Vandal DM | 13 Villain |
| 7 Venatic Riff | 14 Vena-Bull |

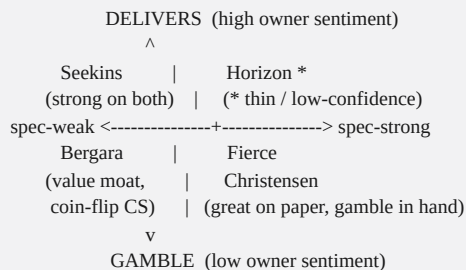
04 / DELIVERY

DOES THE MARKET BELIEVE EACH BRAND DELIVERS?

The spec score above — even corrected — measures only the **promise** any brand can print. This section measures **delivery**: five researchers scored real owner sentiment (Rokslide, Snipers Hide, Reddit, Hunt Talk, AR15.com), independent lab/press tests, and warranty/CS signals (BBB, Trustpilot) on five 0–10 dimensions. A separate Confidence rating keeps the data asymmetry honest — Horizon is a low-volume boutique with ~5× less owner data than Christensen or Bergara, so its lead reads as "strong signal, unproven at scale," not a confirmed #1. Kept deliberately separate from the spec score: the two lenses sit on different scales and confidence levels.

BRAND	ACCURACY IN PRACTICE	BUILD & RELIABILITY	WARRANTY / CS	VALUE SENTIMENT	REPUTATION	COMPOSITE	CONFIDENCE (≈ SRC)
Horizon	8.0	7.5	7.5	8.0	8.0	7.75	Low–Med (~17)
Seekins	7.0	6.0	7.0	8.0	7.5	6.85	Med (~70)
Bergara	7.0	6.5	5.5	8.5	7.0	6.70	Med–High (~55)
Christensen	6.0	4.5	5.0	5.0	4.5	5.10	Med–High (~85)
Fierce	6.0	5.0	4.0	5.0	4.5	5.05	Med (~48)

Weights: Accuracy-in-practice 30% · Build & reliability 30% · Warranty/CS 20% · Value sentiment 10% · Reputation 10%. Composite = weighted sum.



THE INVERSION — The delivery ranking nearly **inverts** the spec ranking. The two brands strongest on paper (Fierce, Christensen) are the ones owners trust **least** to honor it: Fierce "roll the dice... shooter or a boat anchor," a \$200 fee just to invoke the accuracy guarantee, slow CS (delivery 5.05); Christensen a documented ~25–30% QC "lottery," BBB grade D- (5.10). Seekins is the only rival strong on both axes (6.85). Horizon leads delivery (7.75) on thin data — every reachable source says it shoots the 0.5 MOA promise and buyers return, but there is no large-N check. The universal complaint across all four rivals is unit-to-unit QC variance and warranty friction — precisely the space a trusted-delivery brand can take share from, and the one axis a price-cutter cannot copy.

A1 / REFERENCE

COMPETITOR REFERENCE — SEEKINS PRECISION

Every model referenced in any matchup appears here under its brand. Seekins publishes MSRP on its own product pages (the prior edition's "MSRP not published — street estimate" claim was incorrect and inflated Seekins prices 16–32%); the figures below are the exact live-site MSRPs. Seekins also ships a per-rifle fired sub-MOA test target — demonstrated proof credited one accuracy tier above an unverified claim.

SEEKINS PRECISION

MODEL	MSRP	ACTION / BARREL	TRIGGER	GUARANTEE	MAGAZINE	WEIGHT	CHAMBERINGS (REPRESENTATIVE)
Havak PH3	\$1,895	Seekins PH3, 3-lug 60° / 416R SS, 16–26"	TriggerTech 2.5–5 lb	1.0 MOA	AICS-pattern	≈7.0 lb	10: 308W, 22Cr, 25Cr, 6Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7PRC, 7BC, 300WM, 300PRC
Havak PH3 NRL	\$2,295	Seekins PH3, 3-lug / 416R SS fluted, 24"	TriggerTech Primary @2.5 lb	1.0 MOA	AICS-pattern	≈8.5 lb	4 (SA/24"): 25Cr, 6Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC
Havak Element M3	\$2,895	Al/steel hybrid, 3-lug / carbon-wrapped 416R, 16/20/22"	TriggerTech Primary @2.5 lb	1.0 MOA	AICS-pattern	≈6.0 lb	10: 22Cr, 6Cr, 25Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 308W, 7PRC, 7BC, 300WM, 300PRC
Havak HIT Pro M3	\$2,400	HIT Pro M3 folding chassis, 3-lug / 416R M24, 18/24"	TriggerTech Diamond 4–32 oz	1.0 MOA	AICS-pattern, full ARCA	≈9.0 lb	7: .223 Wylde, 22Cr, 6Cr, 25Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 308W

MSRP pulled 2026-07-01 from live manufacturer pages. † discontinued — retained as legacy analog only. Weights are published/representative starting figures; caliber and options vary.

A2 / REFERENCE

COMPETITOR REFERENCE — FIERCE FIREARMS

FIERCE FIREARMS

MODEL	MSRP	ACTION / BARREL	TRIGGER	GUARANTEE	MAGAZINE	WEIGHT	CHAMBERINGS (REPRESENTATIVE)
Carbon Rogue (XP)	\$2,150 (start)	Dual-lug SS 70°, DLC bolt / C3 carbon, 18/20/22"	TriggerTech	0.75 MOA	Rogue C3 carbon stock	≈6.3 lb	11: 22Cr, 6Cr, 25Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7RM, 7PRC, 7BC, 308W, 300WM, 300PRC
CT Rival XP	\$2,999	Dual-lug TITANIUM 70°, DLC bolt / C3 carbon, 20/22"	TriggerTech	0.5 MOA	Rival XP 2.0 carbon, ARCA+Pic	≈6.0 lb	7: 22Cr, 25Cr, 6.5PRC, 280AI, 7BC, 7PRC, 300PRC
Carbon Rage LR	\$3,450	Tri-lug SS 70°, CRF / C3 carbon, NIX brake, 18–24"	TriggerTech	0.5 MOA	Rage C3 carbon, ARCA+Pic	≈7.3 lb	10: 22Cr, 6Cr, 25Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7BC, 7PRC, 28Nos, 300PRC, 338LM
MTN Reaper 2.0	\$3,199	2-lug Ti/SS 70°, DLC / C3 carbon, 18/20/22"	TriggerTech	0.5 MOA	Ultra-Lite Mg folding chassis	≈5.6 lb	10: 22Cr, 25Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7PRC, 7BC, 7RM, 308W, 300WM, 300PRC
Reaper H-TAC 2.0	\$2,699	2-lug SS 70°, DLC, AICS / C3 carbon, 16–22"	TriggerTech	0.5 MOA	Carbon + folding alu chassis, ARCA	≈7.8 lb	10: 22Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 280AI, 7RM, 7PRC, 7BC, 308W, 300WM, 300PRC

MSRP pulled 2026-07-01 from live manufacturer pages. † discontinued – retained as legacy analog only. Weights are published/representative starting figures; caliber and options vary.

A3 / REFERENCE

COMPETITOR REFERENCE — BERGARA

BERGARA

MODEL	MSRP	ACTION / BARREL	TRIGGER	GUARANTEE	MAGAZINE	WEIGHT	CHAMBERINGS (REPRESENTATIVE)
Premier Cima Pro	\$3,099	Premier 416SS, floating bolt head / CURE carbon, 20/22"	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	Autoclave carbon stock (5.5 lb SA)	≈5.5 lb	9: 22Cr, 25Cr, 308W, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 300WM, 7RM, 7PRC, 300PRC
Premier MgLite	\$3,099	Premier, floating bolt head / CURE carbon, 22/24"	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	XLR Element 4.0 Mg chassis, folding	≈6.7 lb	6: 308W, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 300WM, 7PRC, 300PRC
B-14 Squared Crest	\$1,879	B-14 two-lug / 4140 fluted, threaded, 20/22"	Bergara Performance	1.0 MOA	100% carbon fiber (CF-RTM)	≈6.9 lb	6: 308W, 6.5Cr, 22-250, 6.5PRC, 7PRC, 300WM
B-14 Wilderness Ridge	\$1,099 (start)	B-14 two-lug / 4140 No.5, threaded, 20- 24"	Bergara Performance	1.0 MOA	Synthetic SoftTouch, camo	≈7.3 lb	8: 308W, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7PRC, 28Nos, 7RM, 300PRC, 300WM
B-14 Ridge (base)	\$999	B-14 two-lug / 4140 No.5, 18-24"	Bergara Performance	1.0 MOA	Synthetic (GRP)	≈7.5 lb	13 incl. 450 Bushmaster, 308W, 6.5Cr, 22-250, 7-08, 6.5PRC
Premier LRP †	≈\$2,000 (disc.)	Premier / stainless, chassis	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	Aluminum chassis	≈10.9 lb	Discontinued — legacy analog only

MSRP pulled 2026-07-01 from live manufacturer pages. † discontinued — retained as legacy analog only. Weights are published/representative starting figures; caliber and options vary.

A4 / REFERENCE

COMPETITOR REFERENCE — CHRISTENSEN ARMS

CHRISTENSEN ARMS

MODEL	MSRP	ACTION / BARREL	TRIGGER	GUARANTEE	MAGAZINE	WEIGHT	CHAMBERINGS (REPRESENTATIVE)
Mesa FFT	\$1,499.99	Steel / 416R stainless (no carbon wrap), Featherlight, threaded	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	FFT carbon Sporter stock	≈5.9 lb	9: 22Cr, 25Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7RM, 7PRC, 308W, 300WM, 300PRC
Ridgeline FFT	\$2,049.99	Steel Rem700 fp / 416R SS + carbon wrap, threaded	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	FFT carbon Sporter stock	≈5.8 lb	24 calibers, 22Cr → 375 H&H
Ridgeline FFT Titanium	\$2,549.99	TITANIUM receiver / 416R SS + carbon wrap, Ti brake	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	FFT carbon Sporter stock	≈5.3 lb	13: 22Cr → 300PRC
MPR (Modern Precision)	\$2,299.99	Steel Rem700 fp, 20 MOA / 416R SS + carbon wrap, Target	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	7075 alu folding chassis, M-LOK	≈6.9 lb	12: .223, 22Cr, 25Cr, 6ARC, 6Cr, 6.5Cr, 6.5PRC, 7PRC, 308W, 300WM, 300PRC, 338LM
Traverse	\$2,649.99	Rem700-pattern / 416R SS + carbon wrap, threaded	TriggerTech	1.0 MOA	Carbon Monte-Carlo sporter	≈6.8 lb	14 incl. 22-250, 6.5PRC, 28Nos, 300PRC, 375 H&H

MSRP pulled 2026-07-01 from live manufacturer pages. † discontinued — retained as legacy analog only. Weights are published/representative starting figures; caliber and options vary.

B / SOURCES

SOURCES, CORRECTIONS & LIMITATIONS

This corrected edition was produced by an orchestrated multi-agent audit (10 researchers): five web-verified every spec, price and chambering against live 2026 manufacturer sources and tested the prior report against its own scoring rules; five researched owner-delivery sentiment across forums, lab/press tests and warranty signals. Findings were reconciled and the contested matchups recomputed under one consistent ruleset.

WHAT CHANGED VS. THE PRIOR EDITION

- **ACCURACY RULE APPLIED CONSISTENTLY** — an identical guarantee now scores identically for every brand (0.5 MOA = 9.0 for Horizon and Fierce alike); demonstrated proof (Seekins' per-rifle test target) is credited one tier above an unverified claim. This removes a one-directional edge worth +0.2–0.6 to Horizon on the 20%-weighted criterion.
- **TRIGGER BY MODEL** — the same trigger earns the same score; Seekins HIT Pro M3 (TriggerTech Diamond) is credited accordingly, PH3 NRL corrected to TriggerTech Primary.
- **FIERCE CT RIVAL XP RECLASSIFIED** — titanium action, full C3 carbon barrel, 0.5 MOA, ~6 lb (the prior "steel / 0.75 MOA / ~7 lb" described a different rifle).
- **CHRISTENSEN MPR WEIGHT CORRECTED** — real ≈6.9 lb, not the "8–10 lb" previously scored.
- **SEEKINS MSRP** — Seekins publishes MSRP; real figures (\$1,895 / \$2,295 / \$2,895 / \$2,400) replace the inflated street estimates.
- **CHAMBERING COUNTS CORRECTED** — Seekins Element M3 (10), Bergara Premier Cima Pro (9, incl. 22/25 Creedmoor), Fierce Reaper models (10) were previously undercounted.
- **LIVE PRICING** — every MSRP refreshed to 2026-07-01, incl. Christensen's cuts (Mesa FFT \$1,499.99, Ridgeline FFT Ti \$2,549.99) and Bergara's discontinuations (Premier LRP, Ridgeback).
- **SOURCE FIX** — Fierce's site is fiercearms.com (the prior fiercefirearms.com does not resolve).

PRIMARY SOURCES

- **MANUFACTURER SITES** — horizonfirearms.com/core-firearms · seekinsprecision.com · fiercearms.com · bergara.online · christensenarms.com (all pulled 2026-07-01).
- **DELIVERY SENTIMENT** — Rokslide, Snipers Hide, Reddit, Hunt Talk, AR15.com owner threads; independent lab/press tests; BBB & Trustpilot for warranty/CS signals.

LIMITATIONS — Scores are built on published specifications and live MSRP, not measured performance; a corrected accuracy score still reflects a guarantee, not a shot group. The delivery lens (\$04) is confidence-rated because owner-data volume is uneven — Horizon's lead rests on thin, low-N data. Value is weighted 5% by design, understating real purchase-price gaps. Two spreads (Venatic Riff 13" SBR, Vena-Bull .375/.408 Cheytac) have no true current-production analog in the set; their rival scores are directional, not head-to-head.

C / IMPROVE

WHERE HORIZON CAN GAIN — HIGHEST-VALUE MOVES

Ranked by competitive impact, each tied to the criterion it moves. The top three target the heaviest criteria on which Horizon currently loses (Accuracy 20%, Weight 15%, Caliber 10%); the throughline is that Horizon's durable edge is not the spec sheet — where rivals match or beat it — but demonstrated delivery on the promise, the one axis a price-cutter cannot copy and the whole field is weak on.

TIER 1 — HIGHEST LEVERAGE

- **TURN THE GUARANTEE INTO DELIVERED PROOF** — Ship a fired, per-rifle test target (as Seekins does) and make the no-fee, no-questions warranty a marketed weapon. Every rival's dominant complaint is failing to deliver the promise consistently (Fierce's \$200 fee-to-claim, Christensen's D-, Bergara's coin-flip). Publicize the confirmed no-fee guarantee; capture and publish owner-reported group sizes and warranty-honor rates. (Accuracy 20% + the delivery lens.)
- **BROADEN CHAMBERINGS ON FOCUSED MODELS** — Single-caliber models (Vandal Dark II, Villain, Vandal X, Bloodline) score 3.5–4.5 on Caliber vs rivals' 8.6–9.0; this is exactly where the Seekins Element M3 beats us. As the originator of 22 Creedmoor, Horizon should own a broad proprietary menu, or frame the single-calibers as intent. (Caliber 10% — largest recurring deficit.)
- **FIELD A SUB-6 LB MOUNTAIN OPTION** — Horizon hunters run 7–7.5 lb where Christensen Ti is ~5.3 lb and Fierce carbon 5.6–6.3 lb; weight is where the mountain matchups are lost outright. The forthcoming XLR-Atom magnesium-chassis SBR is the first sub-6 lb answer — extend the lightweight approach to a full-length mountain SKU. (Weight 15% — second-heaviest.)

TIER 2 — CLEAN, LOWER-COST GAINS

- **STANDARDIZE THE PREMIUM TRIGGER ON CHASSIS VANDALS** — chassis rivals ship the TriggerTech Diamond; a low-cost BOM change closes a buyer-noticed gap. (Trigger 9%.)
- **MAKE THE PRICE PREMIUM LEGIBLE** — Horizon is +\$300 to +\$900 above the nearest analog at most tiers (wider vs Christensen/Bergara chassis guns). Either sharpen a value tier or make the premium visible via proof targets, lifetime support and demonstrated build. (Value — 5% in scoring, decisive in real purchases.)
- **PUBLISH COMPLETE, VERIFIABLE SPEC SHEETS** — several Horizon weights and trigger grades are unpublished, unlike every competitor; cheap credibility that supports the premium-justification story.
- **OFFER LEFT-HAND ACTIONS & WIDER CONFIGURATION**, and improve restock transparency — both widen the addressable market and protect conversion.

STRATEGIC THROUGHLINE — Demonstrated delivery and transparency are how a premium-priced brand earns its premium. That is the one position Bergara's pricing, Fierce's carbon and Christensen's weight cannot take, because it is built on a reputation for living up to the promise — not on a spec sheet. Prove it (per-rifle targets, no-friction warranty, published sentiment) and protect it as volume grows, because the unit-to-unit QC variance that sank every rival appears precisely as volume scales.